



Week 1 Lesson Materials — "The Tense Engine"

Tutor-facing session plan · Isaac Lee · G9 Term 1 · aligns with booklet pp. 3–5 (Tenses & signal words)

⌚ 60 min

🔄 PP after have · past perfect logic

📌 Board + coloured pens + booklet

📄 Homework: Tense Tune-Up (separate)

Session Objective

By the end of the session Isaac can (1) place all 12 tenses on a timeline and name their signal words, (2) explain **why** "had + V3" is needed when one past action happens before another, and (3) self-correct his three signature tense errors: **have wrote** → **have written**, **If she was...** → **If she had been...**, and **was tested** → **was being tested** (preview only — full passive is Week 3).

0 · Arrival Diagnostic

5 min

Three quick questions on paper — do NOT teach first. This reveals his residual state so you know how much of the deep-dive is needed:

- I ____ (write) three essays this month. (tests: PP after have — he wrote "wrote" on Aug 15)
- When we arrived, the film ____ already ____ (start). (tests: past perfect — he wrote "was" for "had been" on June 15)
- True or false: "She has wrote her name." (tests: can he CATCH the error when it's not his own pen?)

If 3/3 → compress Step 2 to 5 min and spend the time on Step 4 story work. If ≤1 → slow down, Step 2 gets full treatment.

1 · Warm-Up: The Two-Clock Story

5 min

Script: "Imagine you get home and your brother says: 'Someone ate my cake!' But you know YOU ate it at 4pm, and he got home at 6pm. When he got home, the cake **had already been eaten**. Two past things — which one happened **FIRST** gets **had + V3**."

Draw the timeline on the board (see board plan below). This is the **WHOLE** of past perfect in one image.

2 · Main Teaching: Build the 12-Box Tense Grid TOGETHER

20 min

Do not hand him the grid — build it. He draws a blank 3×4 table (time × aspect), and you fill it together. He writes the FORMS in his own handwriting (this matters for retention). Use booklet pp. 3–5 as the reference, but the grid is his own artifact.

	Simple	Continuous	Perfect	Perfect Cont.
Past	V2 / V-ed signal: yesterday, last..., ago, in 1997	was/were + -ing signal: while, at 6pm	had + V3 signal: by the time, before, after	had been + -ing signal: for, since (past)
Present	V / V-s signal: every day, always, never	am/is/are + -ing signal: now, Look!, at the moment	have/has + V3 signal: already, since, yet, just	have been + -ing signal: all day, for, since
Future	will + V predictions, decisions	will be + -ing in progress at a future time	will have + V3 signal: by, by the time	will have been + -ing duration at a future point

Two observations to land hard (these are his gaps):

- The **ENTIRE** perfect column is **have-family + V3**. Never V2. Circle the column in red. "have + wrote" is impossible — the moment you see have/had/will have, the verb **MUST** go to V3.
- The continuous column is **ALWAYS be-family + -ing**. He knows this; naming the pattern gives him the label.

3 · The V3 Factory — Irregular Verb Families

10 min

His June errors were all in the **All-Different** family (V1 ≠ V2 ≠ V3). Drill these as **CHANTS** — say, cover, write, check:

Family	V1 → V2 → V3	His error it kills
All Different (the danger zone)	write → wrote → written	"have wrote"
	take → took → taken	"had not took"
	break → broke → broken	family pattern
	forget → forgot → forgotten	
Two-Change (his June wins ✅)	bring → brought → brought	FIXED Aug 15
	leave → left → left	FIXED Aug 15
No-Change (his April win ✅)	hit → hit → hit	FIXED Aug 15

Point at his wins: "You already killed three of these families in August. The V3 column is the same skill — one column to the right."

4 · Application: Signal-Word Treasure Hunt + Mini Story

15 min

4a — Signal-word treasure hunt (5 min).

Open booklet p.4–5. Call out signal words (*by the time · while · since · yesterday · already · all day · at 6pm · never*) — Isaac points to the grid cell and says the tense. Rapid-fire, keep score out of 10.

4b — Tense-shift story (10 min).

Tell a 5-sentence story orally with deliberate blanks; Isaac writes the verbs. Story frame (typhoon theme — recycles his school world):

1. Yesterday morning, Charles ____ (wake up) at 5:30.

2. While he ____ (walk) to the bus stop, it ____ (start) to rain.

3. When he arrived at school, the gates ____ already ____ (close).

4. He realised he ____ (forget) his umbrella at home.

5. By lunchtime, the school ____ (announce) that all classes would end early.

Answers: woke up · was walking / started · had closed · had forgotten · had announced. Every blank is one of HIS error types: interrupted action, before-ness, V3 after had.

5 · Preview + Confidence Calibration

5 min

Anti-over-flagging inoculation (do this EVERY week): "Next week's homework has True/False questions. Some sentences are CORRECT on purpose. Last time you circled F for a sentence that was actually fine. Rule: **T is a real answer, not a trap**. Before you circle F, ask yourself: can I NAME the error? If you can't name it, it's probably T."

Homework briefing: "The Tense Tune-Up sheet — Part A is warm-up T/F, Part B signal words, Part C a story like today's, Part D fixing YOUR OWN past mistakes, Part E writing 3 sentences. 20 marks, about 25 minutes. Answer key is on the last page — check AFTER you finish, honestly."

Board Plan

PAST

NOW

FUTURE

cake eaten ✓
(had + V3)
↑
"When he got home,
the cake HAD
already been eaten"

by Friday → will have + V3

PERFECT = "BEFORE-ness" → have-family + V3 (never V2!)

CONTINUOUS = "IN-progress" → be-family + -ing

Error-Handling Cues (if you see... → do...)

⚠ If he writes "**have wrote / had forgot**" → don't correct directly. Point at the grid's perfect column and ask: "which column are you in? What does that column demand?" Let him self-repair — self-repair is what stuck in August.

⚠ If he over-uses **past perfect** everywhere after today (his known pattern: new rule → over-application) → immediately teach the boundary: "past perfect ONLY when a SECOND past action exists as a reference point. One past action alone = simple past." Write both versions of one sentence and compare.

⚠ If he flags a CORRECT sentence as wrong → "Name the error. If you can't name it, it's T." Log false-flag count in the Master Log — target 0 by Week 10.

⚠ If story sentences drop the 3rd-person **-s** ("the school announce") → final-check routine out loud: "scan every verb — he/she/it + -s?"

After-Session: Record These (Master Log)

- Diagnostic score (0–3) → this is the Week 1 baseline for the tense thread
- Treasure-hunt score (/10)
- Story blanks correct (/5) — note WHICH type failed: interrupted action / before-ness / V3 form
- False-flag count (target ≤ 1)
- Homework handed over? Date due (next session)